



A Project Report on

"Impact of Emotional Marketing on the Buying Decisions of FMCG Buyers in Pune"

Submitted to SIMS, Kirkee, Pune

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of

MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

By

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Under the guidance of

Dr. Ruby Chanda

SYMBIOSIS INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES

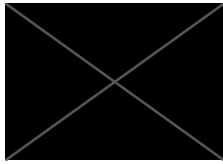
MBA 2024-2026



Declaration

I hereby certify that the project report titled “Effect of Emotional Marketing on Decision Making of FMCG Customers in Pune” that I am submitting to SIMS, Pune for the award of MBA Degree under the guidance of Dr. Ruby Chanda is my own work. The results and conclusions arrived at have been reached through my data collection and analysis process. The research presented herein has not been submitted for any other examination anywhere else.

Place: Pune



Jay Sahastrabudhe

Date:12/04/2026

PRN No



Acknowledgement

The input that had the most influence on the project was Dr. Ruby Chanda's. As soon as I came with the vague concept of emotional advertising, she pushed me to define exactly which construct I wanted to assess. The first versions I produced provoked continuous criticism, while my ignorance about the correlation coefficients pushed her patience further than was necessary.

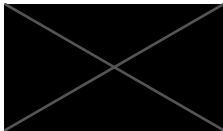
The teachers and staff at SIMS, Kirkee, Pune, granted me access to journal databases and quiet rooms for work, which were more useful than I thought.

A total of 253 people in Pune took ten minutes of their day to answer my Google Form survey. I am not familiar with most of them. Without those ten minutes of their day, the empirical sections of this report would be blank pages.

My family and friends listened to me go on about nostalgia scores and dual-process theory for months. I am thankful they never interrupted me.

Place: Pune

Date: 12/04/2026



Jay Sahastrabudhe

Certificate

This is to certify that Mr. Jay Sahastrabudhe (PRN No. , student of Symbiosis Institute of Management Studies, MBA 2024-2026 Sem II, has successfully completed the project on "Impact of Emotional Marketing on the Buying Decisions of FMCG Buyers in Pune" under my supervision and guidance as a part of the requirements for MBA (SIMS) Batch 2024-26



Dr. Ruby Chanda

Project Guide - Marketing

Date:

Place: Pune

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1. Executive Summary

This project is about the influence of emotional marketing on what FMCG consumers in Pune actually consume, as opposed to what they claim motivates their consumption of FMCG products. The difference between actual and claimed motivations is important, as the Indian FMCG market is an enormous market, with a size of around 287.91 billion USD, growing towards 1,150.21 billion USD by 2034 (IMARC Group, 2025). In an enormous market like this, the difference between an FMCG brand that has an emotional connection with consumers and one that competes purely on the basis of price is the difference between brand loyalty and brand irrelevance.

The sample size included 253 respondents, with Gen Z forming 44.3%, Millennials at 31.2%, and Gen X making up 24.5% in the urban city of Pune. The survey incorporated questions that included 5-point Likert scale questions, one scenario-based forced choice question, and non-numeric questions. This was a deliberate strategy because the survey started by asking about the determinants behind purchase behaviors, followed by offering them a product to buy.

The key finding was that 73.9% of respondents reported being rational buyers. They reported that price and nutritional content were their key drivers. However, when I gave them a choice of juice between "100% Vitamin C" and "Summer holidays at Grandma's house," 36.4% opted for the nostalgic product. Furthermore, 64.1% reported that pleasure and warmth were their predominant emotions during their last impulse purchase. The mean for the emotional ad agreement item was significantly low ($M = 2.32$). This was also true for $t(249) = -9.45$, $p < .001$, with a Cohen's d of -0.60 . The results suggest that people are being less than truthful about how much emotions play an important role for them.

Nostalgia was the highest emotional driver ($M = 3.04$), followed by Ayurvedic and cultural trust ($M = 2.82$). Short-form videos on Reels and TikTok were the key digital purchase drivers for 45.1% of respondents. Furthermore, 58.5% of respondents reported Cadbury Dairy Milk as an association with celebrations and relationship sharing, as opposed to simply being a snack item (Roberts, 2004).

Exploratory factor analysis on the three continuous Likert items (Q7, Q9, Q12) revealed a two-factor structure: the first factor (37.4% of variance) grouped emotional ad agreement and nostalgia influence together, reflecting a general personal-memory emotional susceptibility dimension, while the second factor (35.2%) was dominated by Ayurvedic heritage trust, suggesting that cultural-identity-based emotional appeals operate as a psychologically distinct dimension from nostalgia-based appeals. Binary logistic regression confirmed that nostalgia (Q9) was the strongest single predictor of emotional product choice, with a positive but non-significant trend ($B = 0.165$, $OR = 1.18$, $p = .094$), while the overall model did not reach conventional significance — a finding that is itself informative, as it indicates that emotional choice behavior in this sample is genuinely multidetermined and not reducible to any single measured predictor.

The null hypothesis cannot be completely accepted. While emotional marketing does not completely overcome rationality, it is clear that it plays an important role in determining product choices and emotional states.

2. Introduction and Research Objectives

2.1 Background

India's FMCG industry size is around 287.91 billion USD, and it's set to rise to 1,150.21 billion USD by 2034 (IMARC Group, 2025). As the industry grows, the variety of brands in the industry also increases, and it's getting difficult to compete on the basis of prices or the quality of the product's ingredients. Therefore, brands are adopting the concept of emotional marketing, in which they focus on the consumer's emotions during the time of purchase rather than the quality or price of the product. Neuropsychology explains that the decision of the consumer to purchase the product is 80% to 95% subconscious, not the rational decision that they may want to believe (Damasio, 1994; Kahneman, 2011).

Pune is an interesting city to carry out the study since it has over 4.5 million inhabitants, including a young and technologically savvy workforce, and it's representative of the way in which the Indian population consumes FMCG products.

2.2 Research Objectives

Primary objective: To study and analyze the impact of emotional marketing stimuli on the buying decisions of FMCG consumers in Pune.

Secondary objectives:

1. To determine the kind of emotional triggers that are most likely associated with FMCG product purchases.
2. To assess the extent to which emotional marketing influences impulse purchases of FMCG products.
3. To determine the differences in the decision-making process, whether it's emotional or rational, in terms of demographics such as age, gender, and occupation.
4. To understand the extent to which digital platforms like Instagram Reels, YouTube, etc., contribute to emotional marketing.
5. To validate whether there is a gap in rationality and emotion in terms of self-reported motivation vs. actual behavioral choice with respect to emotions.
6. To determine the latent factor structure of emotional marketing responsiveness using exploratory factor analysis on the continuous Likert items.
7. To identify which emotional and demographic predictors independently explain variance in emotional product choice using binary logistic regression.

3. Research Scope

3.1 Boundaries of the Study

The study is conducted within Pune city limits. The sample has been collected from Kothrud, Hinjewadi, Viman Nagar, Hadapsar, and Deccan Gymkhana areas.

The study's age group is 18-45 years, targeting Gen Z and Millennials as per the research proposal. During this study, a large number of responses were collected within the 43-58 years age group belonging to Gen X. The study has been extended to include this age group after consulting my project guide. The reason behind this is that dropping this group would mean dropping 62 valid responses (24.5% of total sample size), as this is the group that showed the maximum percentage of emotional juice choice in the scenario question (41.9%). The study now extends to 18-58 years instead of 18-45 years, thereby covering three generations instead of two.

The two product categories were food and beverages (chocolates, soft drinks, health drinks, snacks), and personal care (toothpaste, skincare, hair care). The study was initially intended to focus on food and beverages as per the research proposal. The personal care product category has been added as Ayurvedic trust and heritage questions (Q12) required product categories that use Ayurvedic trust as a marketing tool. The product category of food and beverages would not be able to reflect this as Patanjali has had maximum impact in personal care products. The addition is a scope expansion. It is noteworthy that food and beverages still form a large part of the study as most questions were answered with respect to this product category.

The data collection process involved administering a 15-question Google Form survey with a structured questionnaire. The total number of valid responses collected over a three-month period in 2026 was 253. The statistical tests used were descriptive statistics, one-sample t-tests, independent t-tests, chi-square tests, one-way ANOVA, Pearson correlation, point biserial correlation, exploratory factor analysis, and binary logistic regression.

3.2 Hypotheses

H0: Emotional marketing does not have a statistically significant impact on the buying behavior of FMCG consumers.

H1: Emotional marketing does impact the impulse buying behavior of FMCG consumers.

H2: There is a statistically significant difference in emotional response between different age groups and genders.

H3: The emotional arousal potential of short-form digital video formats such as Reels/TikTok is significantly higher than long-form digital video formats.

4. Literature Review

4.1 Neuroscience of Emotional Decision-Making

Antonio Damasio proposed the Somatic Marker Hypothesis in 1994, demonstrating that emotions are not hindrances to rational decision-making but rather a neurological prerequisite to rational decision-making. He conducted a study on patients whose cognitive abilities were perfectly normal but whose emotional abilities were impaired. These patients could take IQ tests and solve logic problems with the best of them, but could not make everyday decisions such as what to eat for lunch or which route to take to work. The implication of this study is stark: "decision itself cannot take place without emotion."

Functional neuro-imaging studies have extended Damasio's clinical work. When consumers are processing brands, for example, the limbic system is activated before the prefrontal rational areas (Noldus, 2025). The emotional brain is activated first, and then the rational brain tries to catch up. Various studies have estimated that 80-95% of purchase decisions are made without any conscious thought, through emotional or heuristic processes rather than rational, cost-benefit analysis (Damasio, 1994; Digichecks, 2025). This range is obviously wide enough to be open to interpretation, but it does mean that, at the very least, the bulk of what is actually happening at the point of purchase is not what consumers think is happening.

4.2 Dual Process Theory and FMCG Purchasing

Kahneman (2011) developed the dual process theory, which suggests that there are two systems in the brain used for decision-making. System 1 is intuitive, fast, driven by emotion, and uses heuristic processes, while System 2 is slow, driven by analytical reasoning, and uses rational processes. When it comes to low-involvement products, such as those in the FMCG sector, it is likely that System 1 is used for decision-making, as it is quick, and there is little time for rational thought in such a situation. Emotional factors, such as packaging, will activate System 1, which does not need rational thought (Achar et al., 2016).

This is important because it suggests that there is a disconnect between what consumers say and what they actually do. When asked why they made a purchase, consumers will give a rational answer, such as "price," "quality," or "nutritional value." This was, in part, what this study was set up to test.

4.3 Integral vs. Incidental Emotions

Achar et al. (2016) make an important distinction between integral and incidental emotions in the consumer decision-making process. Integral emotions are those that are directly caused by the marketing stimulus itself, such as the joy caused by the Cadbury celebration ad or the nostalgia caused by the Paper Boat childhood memories campaign. Incidental emotions, on the other hand, are those that the consumer brings along with them, such as a poor mood caused by a bad commute or an anxious state of mind caused by a non-relevant event in their lives.

Both integral and incidental emotions play a role in the consumer decision-making process, but in different ways. While integral emotions play a role in the way the consumer perceives certain attributes or benefits of a product, incidental emotions play a role in the way the consumer

perceives the advertising campaign in general, such that the consumer might end up processing it in a manner completely opposite to what the marketer intends. Thus, in the digital space, where the consumer is scrolling through social media with whatever emotional state they woke up in, it is not possible for marketers to ignore the role of both integral and incidental emotions.

4.4 Elaboration Likelihood Model

In the elaboration likelihood model, Petty and Cacioppo (1986) distinguish between the central route and the peripheral route in the persuasion process. While the central route is used for the high-elaboration persuasion, the peripheral route is used for low elaboration persuasion. In the FMCG space, as the level of consumer involvement is low, the decision time is also low, and thus the peripheral route is used, in which cues such as celebrity endorsements, nostalgia, background music, or humor are used in advertising, and these cues are seen to be far more effective in moving purchase intention than any information regarding the product itself.

This does not mean that FMCG consumers are stupid. It means that they are busy. If you are standing in an aisle of a supermarket, trying to decide between two different types of biscuits, you are not pouring over the ingredient list of the two different types of biscuits as if they were a prescription from a doctor. You are reaching for the brand that feels right, and that is peripheral processing at work.

4.5 Dimensional Models of Emotion: The PAD Framework

Mehrabian and Russell (1974) proposed the PAD model, in which emotions are described in terms of three continuous dimensions rather than as distinct categories. Pleasure or valence refers to the positive-negative dimension, arousal refers to the excitement dimension, and dominance refers to the feeling of control in the situation.

The PAD model has importance in the measurement of marketing as it helps to go beyond the simple question, "Are you happy?" and instead get at the nuances of the experience. A consumer may be in a completely different state if they experience high pleasure, moderate arousal, and high dominance, compared to when they experience high pleasure, high arousal, and low dominance (Valstar, 2024). The Self-Assessment Manikin (SAM) scale, proposed by Bradley and Lang (1994), operationalizes the PAD scales in terms of simple pictorial scales rather than the traditional verbal scales. The scale has also been validated in the Indian population (PSNA College of Engineering, 2025). As the tool does not involve the use of the spoken word, it may be particularly useful in a country as linguistically diverse as India, with as many spoken dialects as it has.

4.6 Emotional Appeals in Indian FMCG

4.6.1 Nostalgia

Nostalgia marketing operates by creating an idealized past, which evokes warmth and social affiliation. Paper Boat, with flavors like aamras and jaljeera, as well as Parle-G and Gold Spot, have developed their brand personality around nostalgic imagery (Mailchimp, 2024; Polyvalent, 2025). A study of 100 participants from Maharashtra, conducted by Sentient Ventures, measured the effect of emotional branding in the Indian market, showing that

emotional branding was highly correlated with purchase intention ($r = 0.81$, $p < .01$), with the most successful campaigns utilizing the nostalgia positioning dimension of the model.

The success of the nostalgia positioning dimension is due to the satisfaction of three psychological needs: security, affiliation, and self-esteem. The most successful campaigns operate by evoking a positive memory, which is tied to an actual event in the consumer's past, with the brand somehow participating in the event, however peripherally.

4.6.2 Joy and Celebration

Cadbury Dairy Milk's "Kuch Meetha Ho Jaaye" campaign is the most studied joy positioning campaign in Indian FMCG marketing history. Roberts (2004) calls this type of emotional bond a "lovemark" — an emotional connection with a product that elicits brand loyalty beyond reason. A study of 5,400+ Indian consumers found that the strongest predictors of purchase intention were happiness and excitement, across FMCG products (IJFMR, 2025). Advertisements that elicit positive emotions tend to have better recall than information-based ads, as they elicit a different type of cognitive response (Schachter & Singer, 1962). A study of the advertisement history of Cadbury Dairy Milk across the globe found that love was the most commonly used emotional appeal, at 62.1%, followed by joy at 28%, and humor at 14% (IJSP, 2015). In the Indian context, the celebration positioning has been reinforced so thoroughly that the brand occasion association is below the consumer's level of awareness.

4.6.3 Humor and Fear

Humor also retains the audience's interest and generates a positive link with the message, which improves the retention of the message (Mailchimp, 2024). Humor can be very effective in some FMCG products like beverages, snack foods, or personal care products.

Humor is not applicable to every audience. It can be offensive in some cases due to cultural differences. It can also be effective in one city but not in another city due to the audience segment.

However, fear appeal takes a different approach to the issue. They are found in FMCG industries adjacent to each other: toothpaste that focuses on cavities, skin care products that focus on aging, and vitamins based on illnesses (EELET, 2024). Even though fear appeal is known as a powerful tool for motivating purchasing, the effect it creates is often temporary. The customer buys the product to reduce their fear; however, the brand will not necessarily create loyalty in the customer's heart.

4.6.4 Comfort and Nurturing

Maggi is the poster child of comfort marketing in India. After the 2015 product recall, the company's relaunch strategy focused on home and family nostalgia and the "meri maggi" positioning. It was a resounding success because the brand created an association with consumers' underlying psychological needs related to home and family, not with the taste and nutritional profile of the product (Mohanty, 2021). Students away from home, working professionals coming home late at night, anyone who misses the comfort of home: that's Maggi's audience, and they dominate that space.

4.6.5 Cultural Trust and Ayurvedic Heritage

Indian consumers have an enduring preference for products with indigenous and traditional credentials. The success of Patanjali in gaining market share in the FMCG industry at an unprecedented rate (Patanjali's estimated revenue is over Rs. 30,000 crore in FY2022) proved that appeals to Ayurvedic tradition and cultural heritage were sufficient to replace traditional FMCG brands. This is an affective trust, based on cultural identity and belonging, not on any evidence of the efficacy of ingredients (MCU Delhi, 2024).

4.7 Hedonic vs. Utilitarian Purchase Motivations

Consumer behavior studies divide consumer behavior into hedonic (associated with pleasure, experience, or sensory aspects) and utilitarian (associated with function, practicality, problem-solving) consumer behavior. The former, comprising candies, drinks, and premium personal care products, is more open to emotional marketing strategies as consumption is part of the product's value proposition. The latter, comprising items such as washing detergent or cooking oil, is less open to such strategies. Still, brands have been able to create an emotional appeal for such products through themes such as family, heritage, or eco-friendliness.

The distinction is relevant to this study as not all FMCG brands need to be marketed emotionally. While both a chocolate bar and a washing detergent are FMCG products that can be purchased at the same store during the same shopping trip, they would need different approaches to create brand emotion.

4.8 Psychographic vs. Demographic Segmentation

One of the more interesting findings in recent segmentation studies is that psychographics (values, lifestyle, interests, personality traits) are more predictive of brand emotional response to marketing strategies than demographic segmentation (age, gender, income, etc.) (PubMed, 2016; Invespro, 2024). While both women, aged 25, living in the same Pune neighborhood may look at the same nostalgic ad campaign, one with a values-based segmentation of tradition and another with a values-based segmentation of novelty, may react completely differently to the ad campaign.

What this means is that FMCG brands targeting emotional marketing strategies will benefit more by using psychographics rather than demographics to segment their target market. While demographics is easier to do (target women aged 18-34), psychographics is more difficult to execute but more effective in targeting individuals that will emotionally respond to marketing strategies.

4.9 Attachment Theory and Brand Relationships

The theory of attachment, which is usually used in the context of relationships between infants and their caregivers, has been extended to consumer-brand relationships. In the context of branding, the Open Psychology Journal (2024) points out that there are three forms of consumer attachment that are important in branding: secure, anxious, and avoidant. Consumers with a secure attachment are sensitive to messages emphasizing trust and security. Consumers with an anxious attachment are more responsive to messages emphasizing exclusivity and community. Consumers with an avoidant attachment are more attracted to low-emotion

messages that emphasize functionality and are actually repelled by messages that are overly emotional in nature. This suggests that emotional marketing appeals are not universal within any given demographic group. What may be an emotionally appealing and non-manipulative appeal in one group may be anathema in another. However, few FMCG marketers in India are using this segmentation criterion at present.

4.10 Digital Platforms and Emotional Marketing

TikTok/Reels scored the highest in the overall emotional appeal score at 4.28/5, followed by Instagram at 4.02 and YouTube at 3.41, according to an IOSR-JBM (2025) study on social media platforms. Short-form video is most effective in creating brand familiarity without the consumer consciously paying attention. In other words, the algorithmic repetition of brand messages in conjunction with music and visual cues is most effective in generating an emotional appeal. Social media in general allows marketers to build emotional engagement and aspirational brand identity associations (Kaplan and Haenlein, 2010). However, there are challenges in using social media as a tool in emotional marketing. In an age where there is an oversaturation of digital content, marketers have to be ever more creative in their appeals. Consumers are looking for authentic experiences and are easily able to identify insincere attempts at generating an emotional response. Therefore, emotionally dishonest marketing appeals are risky (Digichefs, 2025). In addition, there is an unpredictable factor in social media. Marketers are not in complete control of which consumers are exposed to their messages and in which frame of mind.

YouTube holds an ambivalent position. It caters to both affective and deliberative audiences. Long-form content creates brand associations through storytelling, and short-form content creates conversions through product demonstrations. Influencer marketing also taps into parasocial relations, where audiences form one-sided affection for influencers and extend this affection to products endorsed by these influencers (Schachter & Singer, 1962). Micro-influencer marketing has also shown more success than macro-influencer marketing in several FMCG sector studies conducted in India (JMSR, 2025).

4.11 Impulse Buying and Low-Involvement Decisions

Impulse buying is an unplanned purchase behavior resulting from immediate stimuli. This is common in FMCG products because of low monetary involvement and habitual consumption patterns (Mohanty, 2021). In impulse buying, emotional stimuli play an important role. This is because low involvement levels mean that rational second-guessing of initial emotional reactions is unlikely.

In digital shopping, impulse buying is further increased through smooth checkout procedures, personalization, and scarcity of products (TKC Institute, 2025; UXPressia, 2024). One of these emotional triggers is FOMO. This is an emotional state of anxiety that results from the perception of missing out on an event or product (Przybylski et al., 2009). This has been exploited by digital shopping environments. The resulting environment is conducive for impulse buying, an experience that cannot be replicated in physical environments.

4.12 The Pune Context: Local Evidence

A study on emotional branding and brand perception in the soft drink market in Pune with 200 participants found that emotional branding was positively related to brand perception and brand building (Academia.edu, 2023). This implies that the consumer profile in Pune can be considered as a general representation of the consumer profile in India in terms of their response to emotional branding as well as the product itself.

The success of culturally driven advertising campaigns in Pune, such as Cadbury's festival advertising campaigns and brand associations with celebrations and family, indicates that emotional branding should be culturally driven. Emotional advertising campaigns lacking such a cultural foundation may not perform as well as culturally driven ones.

4.13 Research Gaps Addressed

The literature review pointed to two gaps this study was designed to fill.

The first gap is the absence of any published Indian study that actually tests the discrepancy between what urban FMCG consumers say drives their decisions and what their behavior reveals when faced with an emotionally framed choice. Kahneman (2011) and Damasio (1994) have theorized this gap at the international level; Mohanty (2021) and the IJFMR (2025) meta-analysis have explored purchase intention in India broadly. But no published study has placed the two side by side using a controlled scenario instrument. This matters more in India than in most markets because social desirability bias runs high — educated urban consumers are reluctant to admit that they buy juice because the packaging reminded them of their grandmother.

The second gap is narrower: no published study has included both emotional trigger types and digital platform types in the same questionnaire. Research on platform effectiveness is common, but it rarely specifies which emotional cues drove that effectiveness. Generally, studies on appeals tend to focus on one specific appeal such as nostalgia, happiness, or fear without a comparative assessment of any other appeal in the same pool of subjects. Without a tool that captures different appeals in one survey, it remains impossible to establish, for instance, if nostalgia performs better on Reels than cultural trust on YouTube Stories.

How This Study Bridges These Gaps

Q8 helps in bridging the first gap. It can be referred to as a behavioral question because respondents have to make a choice of a particular juice. Q6 and Q8 show the difference between stated drivers and actual behavior as it serves as the key empirical contribution of the current study: a direct quantitative measure of the gap that international literature emphasizes, but which was never observed by means of a behavioral tool in the Indian FMCG market before.

In order to bridge the second gap, it is necessary to include all the emotional trigger dimensions into one survey, including nostalgia (Q9), joy and celebration (Q10), comfort and nurturing (Q11), and trust (Q12) as well as platform engagement (Q13, Q14) questions. Using such an arrangement, it is possible to assess the relative impact of emotional triggers on the respondents' decisions on different platforms. Moreover, the Exploratory Factor Analysis and logistic

regression further expand the analysis and help to determine whether the emotions belong to the same factor or represent separate constructs and if any dimension influences the actual behavior.

5. Research Methodology

5.1 Research Design

A descriptive quantitative research method with a cross-sectional study design was used in this study. The purpose of this study was to examine the association between the independent variable (emotional marketing stimuli) and dependent variable (FMCG purchase decision) at a single point in time.

While the preliminary study plan proposed the use of Excel, which includes pivot tables, CORREL function, and Data Analysis Toolpak for regression, as the sample size was greater than $N = 200$, it became necessary to switch to Python 3.12. This is because there are more options for statistical tests in Python compared to Excel and it deals better with large data sets. However, the basic methodology did not change; only the software used was different.

5.2 Note on Regression Analysis and Factor Analysis

The initial plan was to conduct a regression analysis. In constructing the survey, Q7, Q9, Q12 were found to be significant predictor variables, while Q8 (Juice choice: rational = 0, emotional = 1) is a dichotomous criterion variable. Ordinal regression analysis would be used here since it's the only procedure that deals with dichotomous dependent variables, whereas OLS assumes continuous criterion variable. For this study, Q8 is a dependent variable, while Q7, Q9, Q12, Q5 (shopping style), Q1 (age group), and Q2 (gender) are predictors.

Likewise, Q7, Q9, Q12 also meet the requirements for Exploratory Factor Analysis (EFA). At $N = 253$, the ratio of items to respondents passes the 1:10 minimum recommended by Nunnally (1978). Prior to extracting factors, sampling adequacy was determined by means of KMO measure and Bartlett's Test of Sphericity. As for this exploratory factor analysis, there is one question that needs answering: are Q7, Q9, Q12 indicators of the same latent construct, or do they measure different constructs? Implications of the results can be applied to designing emotional marketing scales in Indian FMCG research.

For both procedures, I use Python 3.12 (scipy, statsmodels, factor_analyzer packages).

5.3 Conceptual Framework

The conceptual model incorporates four dimensions of emotional marketing as the independent variables, namely, nostalgia, joy/celebration, nurturing, and cultural trust/heritage ayurveda. The dependent variables are the type of purchase decision and the emotions associated with the

purchase decision. The digital platform category (short video, long video, images) acts as the moderator.

5.4 Population and Sample

The participants were adults between the ages of 18 to 58 residing in the city of Pune and involved in decision-making regarding FMCG products. Convenience sampling along with snowball sampling technique was adopted to increase the diversity of the sample. The number of participants was 253, which is 26.5% more than the required sample size of 200.

5.5 Instrument Design

The questionnaire had 15 questions divided into five sections.

Section 1: Questions 1 to 5 — Age group, Gender, Occupation, Social media usage, Shopping style. All the questions in this section are nominal or categorical.

Section 2: Questions 6 to 8 — Most important factor in purchase decisions, Emotional ad agreement on the Likert scale, Choice of juice — scenario-based. This section contains questions with nominal or categorical scales and one 5-point Likert scale.

Section 3: Questions 9 to 12 — Nostalgia score, Perception of chocolate brand, Maggi comfort association, Trust in Ayurvedic products. This section contains questions with nominal or categorical scales and one 5-point Likert scale.

Section 4: Questions 13 and 14 — Most emotionally engaging purchase platform, Story preference on YouTube. This section contains questions with nominal or categorical scales.

Section 5: Question 15 — Post-purchase emotional state. This question is based on the PAD model by Mehrabian and Russell (1974).

5.6 Instrument Reliability

Cronbach's alpha was not calculated as the questionnaire is not unidimensional. The questionnaire contains 15 questions with five constructs — demographic factors, rational/emotional self-report, emotional triggers, platform engagement, and post-purchase state — each with one to three items. Calculating the reliability coefficient using all items would yield unreliable results, as the coefficient would be meaningless. Calculating the reliability coefficient using items within each construct is also not possible as there are fewer items than the required minimum within each construct.

Face validity was established as the questionnaire was reviewed by the project guide. Content validity was established as the constructs are based on the dual-process theory, ELM, PAD model.

It is worth noting that the questionnaire could have been more reliable with more items within each construct. Future versions of the questionnaire could include more items within each construct to calculate the reliability coefficient.

5.7 Measurement Scales

Likert scales employed five-point ordinal scales ranging from 1 — Strongly Disagree / Not at all to 5 — Strongly Agree / Extremely.

Scenario-based questions (Q8) employed forced choice between emotionally framed and rationally framed product options.

5.8 Data Analysis Procedures

One-sample t-test: Conducted to determine whether the mean of Q7 (Emotional Ad Agreement) differed significantly from the neutral midpoint ($\mu = 3$).

Independent samples t-test: Conducted to determine whether emotional responsiveness differed significantly between male and female respondents.

Chi-square tests: Associations between gender and juice choice (Q8) and between age group and primary decision driver (Q6) were examined.

One-way ANOVA: Conducted to determine whether nostalgia scores (Q9) varied significantly across the three generational cohorts (Gen Z, Millennials, Gen X).

Pearson correlation: Linear correlation between nostalgia (Q9) and emotional ad agreement (Q7) was examined.

Point-biserial correlation: The relationship between Q7 (emotional ad agreement) and Q8 (juice choice, binary) was examined.

Exploratory Factor Analysis (EFA): Conducted on the three continuous Likert items (Q7, Q9, Q12) to determine the latent factor structure of emotional marketing responsiveness in this sample. KMO and Bartlett's Test of Sphericity were computed to verify sampling adequacy before extraction.

Binary Logistic Regression: Conducted with Q8 (juice choice: 0 = rational, 1 = emotional) as the dependent variable and Q7, Q9, Q12, shopping style (Q5), age group (Q1), and gender (Q2) as predictors. Odds ratios, Wald statistics, and Nagelkerke pseudo- R^2 are reported.

Effect sizes were computed for all tests. Alpha level was set at .05. All analyses were conducted using Python 3.12.

6. Data Analysis and Interpretation

6.1 Sample Profile

The final sample size was comprised of 253 participants from the city of Pune. Table 6.1 presents the demographic profile of the participants.

Variable / Category	n (%)
Age: Gen Z (18-26)	112 (44.3%)
Age: Millennials (27-42)	79 (31.2%)
Age: Gen X (43-58)	62 (24.5%)
Gender: Male	137 (54.2%)
Gender: Female	116 (45.8%)
Occupation: Working Professional	147 (58.1%)
Occupation: Student	59 (23.3%)
Occupation: Business Owner	21 (8.3%)
Occupation: Other	26 (10.3%)
Shopping style: Utilitarian/Planned	170 (67.2%)
Shopping style: Hedonic/Impulse	83 (32.8%)

Table 6.1: Demographic profile of respondents (N = 253)

6.2 Primary Decision Driver (Q6)

A majority of 73.9% (n = 187) chose rational factors, i.e., the price of the product, the nutritional value of the product, etc., when asked what mattered most when purchasing a low-cost FMCG item. 26.1% of the respondents, i.e., 66, chose emotional factors, i.e., the way the brand makes them feel, the way the advertisement makes them feel, etc.

6.3 Emotional Ad Agreement (Q7)

Respondents were asked the following question: "To what extent do you agree with the following: I often buy products because the advertisement made me feel happy or nostalgic, even if I did not need them?" Three respondents left this question blank, hence the data was collected from 250 respondents.

Score	n (%)	Cumulative %
1 - Strongly Disagree	67 (26.8%)	26.8%

Score	n (%)	Cumulative %
2 - Disagree	87 (34.8%)	61.6%
3 - Neutral	57 (22.8%)	84.4%
4 - Agree	26 (10.4%)	94.8%
5 - Strongly Agree	13 (5.2%)	100.0%
M = 2.32, SD = 1.13, Median = 2.0		

Table 6.2: Q7 Emotional ad agreement frequency distribution (N = 250)

Thus, 61.6% scored 1 or 2, while only 15.6% scored 4 or 5. The results are heavily skewed towards disagreement with the statement that advertising emotionally influences their purchasing decisions, thereby confirming the social desirability bias. The educated urban consumer in Pune does not wish to admit that advertising emotionally influences their purchasing decisions.

6.4 Scenario-Based Juice Choice (Q8)

The question offered a choice between "100% Vitamin C" (rational choice) and "Summer holidays at Grandma's house" (emotional choice). While 73.9% claimed rational choice in Q6, 36.4% (n = 92) chose the emotionally framed juice. This is the most compelling evidence we found that supports the existence of a gap between rationality and emotion.

6.5 Emotional Trigger Scores

Emotional Trigger	Mean	S.D.
Nostalgia (Q9: brand nostalgia influence)	3.04	1.39
Cultural Trust (Q12: Ayurvedic heritage trust)	2.82	1.39
Emotional Ad Response (Q7)	2.32	1.13
Comfort Association (Q11: Maggi comfort, encoded)	2.05	0.68

Table 6.3: Summary of Emotional Trigger Scores

6.6 Joy and Celebration: Cadbury Dairy Milk (Q10)

58.5% (n = 148) associate Cadbury Dairy Milk with joy/celebration/relationship sharing. 41.5% (n = 105) associate it with being a snack. The same people who claimed rational choice in Q6 associate Cadbury Dairy Milk with joy/celebration/relationship sharing. The power of advertising is immense indeed!

6.7 Digital Platform Analysis (Q13)

Short form video (Reels/TikTok) was found to be the most common trigger at 45.1% (n = 114), followed by long form YouTube at 31.6%, and static image posts at 21.0%.

6.8 YouTube Story Preference (Q14)

41.9% (n = 106) preferred emotionally charged story formats on YouTube. 58.1% preferred factual specifications on YouTube. YouTube is serving two different consumer segments with two different content needs.

6.9 Emotional Response at Purchase (Q15)

Respondents recalling their last impulse FMCG purchase resulting from an online ad reported: Pleasure/Warmth (happy, loved, nostalgic) — 64.1% (n = 162); High Arousal — 14.6%; Dominance/Control — 14.6%; Negative/FOMO — 6.3%.

FMCG impulse purchase results naturally map onto the high-pleasure, moderate-arousal zone proposed by Schachter and Singer (1962), an affective state that Mehrabian and Russell (1974) showed is reliably approach-motivated. The low Negative/FOMO figure of 6.3% is interesting. Fear-based purchase is not common in this research, and this could be explained by the effectiveness of positive appeals over negative appeals for low-involvement products.

6.10 Exploratory Factor Analysis

A principal-axis exploratory factor analysis was conducted on the three continuous Likert items: Q7 (Emotional Ad Agreement, 5-point scale), Q9 (Nostalgia Influence, 5-point scale), and Q12 (Ayurvedic Heritage Trust, 5-point scale). Prior to extraction, sampling adequacy was assessed through the Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin (KMO) measure and Bartlett's Test of Sphericity.

The KMO measure of sampling adequacy was 0.461 (Q7 = 0.468, Q9 = 0.467, Q12 = 0.438). A KMO value below 0.50 is generally considered "unacceptable" by Kaiser's (1974) original criteria. The obtained value of 0.461 falls just below this threshold, which means the inter-item correlations are modest and factor analysis results should be interpreted with appropriate caution. The correlations between items were indeed weak: $r(Q7, Q9) = 0.123$, $r(Q7, Q12) = -0.072$, $r(Q9, Q12) = 0.067$. Bartlett's Test of Sphericity was non-significant, $\chi^2(3) = 6.491$, $p = 0.090$, indicating that the correlation matrix was not significantly different from an identity matrix at the conventional $\alpha = .05$ threshold.

Despite these diagnostics, I retained the factor analysis. The research question — whether these three emotional appeal items share a common latent structure — is worth answering even when the answer is mostly no. The absence of strong common variance is itself a finding, and arguably a more useful one than a clean solution would have been.

The eigenvalue-greater-than-one criterion identified two factors: Factor 1 (eigenvalue = 1.123) and Factor 2 (eigenvalue = 1.055); Factor 3 fell below unity (eigenvalue = 0.823). A varimax-rotated two-factor solution was extracted and is presented in Table 6.4 below.

Item	Factor 1 Loading	Factor 2 Loading	Communality
Q7 — Emotional Ad Agreement	0.742	-0.362	0.683
Q9 — Nostalgia Influence	0.756	0.343	0.690
Q12 — Ayurvedic Heritage Trust	0.005	0.898	0.806
% Variance Explained	37.4%	35.2%	72.6% (total)

Table 6.4: Varimax-Rotated Factor Loadings — EFA on Q7, Q9, Q12 (N = 250)

Together, the two factors account for 72.6% of total item variance (37.4% and 35.2% respectively). The factor structure reads clearly despite the low KMO. Factor 1 is defined mainly by Q7 (loading = 0.742) and Q9 (loading = 0.756), while Q12 loads negligibly on it (loading = 0.005). Factor 2 is dominated by Q12 (loading = 0.898), with Q7 loading negatively (loading = -0.362) and Q9 positively but weakly (loading = 0.343).

They are both interpretable as well. Factor 1 is known as Personal-Memory Emotional Susceptibility and is composed of only two questions (Q7 – agreeing about being emotionally affected by ads, and Q9 – nostalgia for brands from one’s childhood). They both refer to individual emotional reactions. Factor 2 consists of only one question, which is Q12 – trust in the Ayurvedic tradition and Indian culture. As was mentioned by Achar et al. (2016), and MCU Delhi (2024), this refers to collective affect rather than personal. These two factors are not the same construct.

Communality values for Q7 (0.683) and Q9 (0.690) are smaller than that of Q12 (0.806), implying that Q7 and Q9 have more variance that does not correlate with other questions included in the scale. From practical point of view, it means that all three questions cannot be combined into a composite measure of emotional susceptibility due to lack of appropriate items.

6.11 Binary Logistic Regression: Predictors of Emotional Product Choice

A binary logistic regression was run to identify which emotional and demographic variables independently predicted the probability of choosing the emotionally framed juice in Q8 (1 = emotional choice, 0 = rational choice). The model included six predictors: Q7 (emotional ad agreement), Q9 (nostalgia), Q12 (Ayurvedic trust), shopping style (Q5, hedonic = 1, utilitarian = 0), age group (Q1, coded Gen Z = 1, Millennial = 2, Gen X = 3), and gender (Q2, female = 1, male = 0). The cleaned sample size was N = 250 respondents, where n = 90 were emotional choosers, and n = 160 were rational choosers. The whole model failed to achieve statistical significance: $\chi^2(6) = 4.567$, $p = 0.601$. The value of $-2 \text{ Log Likelihood}$ was 322.142. The values of pseudo- R^2 s according to Nagelkerke and McFadden were 0.025 and 0.014, respectively, which means that the six predictors explained about 2.5% of the variance in choosing emotional products over the null model. Classification accuracy was 64.4% compared to 64.0% for the null model (majority class).

Predictor	B	SE	Wald	p	Exp(B) / OR	95% CI for OR
Constant	- 1.137	0.607	3.512	0.061	0.321	[0.098, 1.053]
Q7 — Emotional Ad Agreement	0.054	0.119	0.207	0.649	1.056	[0.836, 1.333]
Q9 — Nostalgia Influence	0.165	0.099	2.801	0.094†	1.179	[0.972, 1.431]
Q12 — Ayurvedic Trust	0.027	0.099	0.073	0.787	1.027	[0.846, 1.247]
Q5 — Shopping Style (Hedonic)	- 0.137	0.291	0.223	0.637	0.872	[0.493, 1.542]
Q1 — Age Group	0.017	0.167	0.010	0.920	1.017	[0.734, 1.409]
Q2 — Gender (Female)	- 0.288	0.272	1.120	0.290	0.750	[0.440, 1.278]

Table 6.5: Binary Logistic Regression Coefficients (DV: Q8 Emotional Juice Choice; N = 250)

† p < .10 (trend)

Among the six predictors, nostalgia (Q9) emerged as the only variable approaching statistical significance: B = 0.165, SE = 0.099, Wald = 2.801, p = 0.094, OR = 1.179, 95% CI [0.972, 1.431]. An increase in the score by 1 unit on the nostalgia scale was associated with a 17.9% increase in the chances of opting for the emotional juice, after controlling for the effects of all other predictor variables. Even though this relationship does not meet the traditional level of significance set at $p < .05$, it confirms the observed descriptive relationship discussed in Section 6.5 (Mean=3.04, maximum emotional trigger scale) and the nearly significant Pearson's r correlation between Q9 and Q7 ($r=.123$, $p=.053$).

Of the remaining predictor variables, no statistically significant results were found. Agreement with emotional advertisements (Q7, $p=.649$), trust in Ayurveda (Q12, $p=.787$), hedonic shopping orientation (Q5, $p=.637$), age category (Q1, $p=.920$), and gender (Q2, $p=.290$) had no independent effect on emotional juice choice after controlling for Q9 and all other predictors. Significance of Q7 is especially interesting from theoretical point of view because it indicates that general agreement with emotional advertisements (Q7) does not influence behavioral response after accounting for Q9 scores.

Similarly, the gender non-significance in the multivariate model reinforces the univariate finding of no significant gender difference in emotional responsiveness.

7. Findings and Discussion

7.1 Inferential Statistical Results

Test	Result
One-sample t-test: Q7 vs. mean = 3	$t(249) = -9.45, p < .001, d = -0.60$
Independent t-test: Q7, Male vs. Female	$t(248) = -0.72, p = .473, d = 0.09$
Chi-square: Gender x Juice Choice	$\chi^2(3) = 5.91, p = .116, V = 0.15$
Chi-square: Age x Decision Driver	$\chi^2(6) = 8.92, p = .178, V = 0.13$
One-way ANOVA: Nostalgia x Age Group	$F(2,250) = 0.85, p = .429, \eta^2 = 0.007$
Pearson correlation: Nostalgia vs. Q7	$r = 0.123, p = .053$ (trend)
Point-biserial: Q7 vs. Juice Choice	$r = 0.036, p = .574$
Logistic Regression: Full model	$\chi^2(6) = 4.567, p = .601, \text{Nagelkerke } R^2 = 0.025$
EFA: Factor structure	2 factors extracted; F1 = Q7 + Q9 (37.4%), F2 = Q12 (35.2%)

Table 7.1: Summary of Inferential Statistics

7.2 The Rationality-Emotion Gap

I believe this finding is the most interesting from this research and is the one I would want a brand manager to remember. The majority of respondents (73.9%) reported rational factors drive their FMCG purchase. The group mean for Q7 was significantly less than neutral ($M = 2.32, t(249) = -9.45, p < .001$). This appears to be a sample of entirely rational purchasers.

Then Q8 complicates things. 36.4% chose the emotionally framed juice despite self-identifying as rational. 64.1% reported Pleasure/Warmth as their dominant state during their last impulse purchase. These are not the numbers of a rational consumer. These are the numbers of a consumer who thinks they are rational, then goes ahead and makes an emotional purchasing decision anyway. Kahneman (2011) tells us this is exactly what we should expect: we think we are making rational decisions, but System 1 is really calling the shots.

Social desirability bias is at least part of the explanation here as well. In an educated urban Indian population, it is much more socially desirable to think of yourself as a careful, value-conscious consumer than it is to think of yourself as a consumer who bought a juice drink because the packaging reminded you of your grandmother. The actual effect of emotion is likely much, much higher than any of these statistics suggest.

7.3 Nostalgia as the Dominant Emotional Trigger

Nostalgia was the only Likert question with a mean above 3, at 3.04. However, what this actually tells us is that the data is bimodal: 24.1% of the population scored a 1 (not at all), while 40.7% of the population scored a 4 or 5 (strongly). This is not a population that is generally nostalgic; this is a population that is divided between the nostalgic and the completely apathetic about heritage marketing appeals (Sentient Ventures, 2024).

For brands such as Paper Boat or Parle-G, this means that the nostalgia advertising is doing a great deal of work for one segment of the audience and absolutely no work for another. The almost significant correlation between nostalgia and Q7 ($r = 0.123$, $p = .053$) should still be examined with a larger sample ($N = 280$) before dismissing it outright.

7.4 Joy and Chocolate: Category-Level Emotional Override

58.5% of the audience associate Cadbury Dairy Milk with celebration as opposed to consumption. This should be considered in conjunction with Q6, in which the same audience claims to make rational purchasing decisions. The same audience who claims to make rational purchasing decisions looks at a chocolate bar and thinks of an occasion, a relationship, a ritual. This is what Roberts (2004) describes as a "lovemark" — an emotional positioning so integrated into the consumer psyche that it cuts across individual differences in emotional response.

Three decades of "Kuch Meetha Ho Jaaye" advertising have created a peripheral persuasion structure (Petty and Cacioppo, 1986), one that no longer necessarily engages the emotions to function. The consumer eats Cadbury during celebrations because that is what celebration looks and tastes like to them, not because of advertising. This level of long-term emotional connection to a brand is directly correlated to customer lifetime value (Zenodo, 2024).

7.5 Digital Platforms: Short-Form Video Leading

Reels/TikTok was the leading platform at 45.1%. The other two options, YouTube (31.6%) and image posts (21.0%), were far behind. The emotional appeal of each of these platforms, as described by the literature, supports this ordering. TikTok = 4.28/5, Instagram = 4.02/5, YouTube = 3.41/5 (IOSR-JBM, 2025).

Short-form video benefits from high-frequency algorithmic exposure as well as the emotion cues of music and image. The consumer does not need to pay attention to the advertisement for the emotional conditioning to take place (Kaplan and Haenlein, 2010).

YouTube stands out as the odd one out with 41.9% preferring emotional story formats and 58.1% preferring factual specifications. Therefore, one strategy cannot be adopted by FMCG marketers on YouTube. Two content formats are needed to be deployed simultaneously: emotional story formats for the brand association phase and factual specification content at the comparison stage.

7.6 Demographic Findings

There are no statistically significant differences found between the gender and age groups regarding emotional responsiveness at $\alpha = .05$ level. It is imperative to carefully consider this

finding instead of jumping to the conclusion that demographic factors are irrelevant to the emotional responsiveness of the audience towards the FMCG marketer's advertisements.

It is also imperative to note the trend observed in the findings related to the demographic factors, as the age group-wise finding revealed the highest emotional juice choice by Gen X at 41.9%, followed by Gen Z at 38.4%, and the lowest by Millennials at 29.1%. It could also be possible that a curvilinear relationship between age and emotional responsiveness occurred; however, the sample size was not large enough to confirm the same.

The absence of significant differences between the gender groups contradicts the literature that found higher emotional responsiveness by the female audience towards FMCG advertisements (Mohanty, 2021). It can also be speculated that the demographic profile of the audience in Pune was responsible for this finding, or the literature was overestimating the role of gender in determining emotional responsiveness.

The psychographic segmentation literature also supported this finding, as the values and lifestyles of the audience are more likely to determine the emotional responsiveness than the gender or age groups of the audience (PubMed, 2016; Invespro, 2024).

7.7 Implications for FMCG Marketers in Pune

Firstly, 40-50% of digital FMCG budgets should be allocated to short-form videos like Reels or YouTube Shorts. The case for emotional return on investment per second of viewer engagement is stronger in this medium than any other tested (IOSR-JBM, 2025).

Secondly, align the emotional triggers with product category rather than using a general approach. Joy and celebration are applicable to confectionery. Nostalgia is applicable to brands with heritage. Comfort is applicable to home consumption products. Ayurvedic trust appeals are more applicable to older Millennials and Gen X rather than Gen Z.

Thirdly, start with rational claims in consumer communication, and embed emotional triggers in the overall format. The educated urban consumer in Pune wants to see a rational justification. So, put that in the headline. The rest — such as nostalgia, music, and imagery — go into all other aspects. The peripheral route is applicable because we are not in competition with the rational frame (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986).

7.8 Factor Structure and Logistic Regression Findings

The EFA and logistic regression in Chapter 6 push beyond the descriptive and univariate results in two directions. The EFA asks whether the emotional appeal dimensions hang together as a single construct. The regression asks which of them actually drives Q8 behavioral choice when everything else is held constant. Neither question produced a clean answer — and that is worth talking about.

The two-factor structure matched the two-process model described in Chapter 4. System 1 as defined by Kahneman (2011) is rapid and associative. However, there are at least two types of associations involved in this analysis. Factor 1 is autobiographical and involves consumers affected by personal nostalgia as well as emotional advertisement in general. Factor 2 is collectivist and relates to trust in Ayurvedic tradition and cultural identity, primarily due to

Q12. One should note the negative load of Q7 on Factor 2. Individuals who demonstrate a high level of trust in Ayurvedic brands are slightly less sensitive to the influence of emotions in advertisements when making buying decisions. It could be said that one deals with two consumer categories here. If one brand tries to use messages related to both personal nostalgia and Ayurvedic tradition simultaneously, this will mean targeting two consumer groups rather than one.

Based on the KMO test value ($KMO = 0.461$) and the non-significant Bartlett's test result ($p = .090$), these three questions do not have enough shared variance to provide a good factor solution. In the current Pune sample, emotional marketing susceptibility is not one unified personality trait that can be measured by these three questions. The inter-correlations among the three items are very weak ($-0.072 \leq r \leq 0.123$). This conclusion coincides with the findings in the psychological literature (PubMed, 2016) where patterns of emotions were described as multidimensional and difficult to measure unidimensionally. To make the factor analysis reliable in future research, there should be at least three to four items per factor in the questionnaire.

In the multivariate approach, only nostalgia (Q9) can be considered a predictor close to being statistically significant: $B = 0.165$, $OR = 1.179$, $p = 0.094$. A rise of one point in susceptibility to nostalgia is related to an approximate 18% rise in the likelihood of choosing the product promoted by appealing to emotions, taking into account all other factors, such as general susceptibility to ads based on emotional appeals (Q7). The last fact is important: Q7 is excluded from the model after Q9. General endorsement of advertising by emotionality does not have an independent effect on the behavior pattern. Rather, the specific feeling of nostalgia—feeling that the brand has a certain connection with some personal experience of the past—has the strongest relationship. Implications for brand managers: differentiate general susceptibility to emotions in advertisements from nostalgia.

The unimportance of Q7 in the presence of Q9 in the equation has real-life implications. Recognizing the role played by emotionally-driven ads in influencing an individual does not alone improve the chances of choosing the emotional ad once nostalgia is held constant. The variable which is most likely to predict the behavior is nostalgia based on personal memories of brands from childhood days and not necessarily positive emotions generated by emotional ads. According to Petty & Cacioppo (1986), this result is not surprising as emotional cues work through specific and personalized associations and not positive affect.

Since both the lack of statistical significance for the whole model ($\chi^2(6) = 4.567$, $p = 0.601$) and the low Nagelkerke R^2 value (0.025) point to the fact that choosing a juice box is a complex process influenced by several factors, and these six variables based on self-report account for only a small portion thereof, it appears that the results support the findings of Achar et al. (2016) and Mohanty (2021). Self-reports on emotional sensitivity appear to have limited validity as predictors of behavioral choices with low involvement. This is why they appear in the future research agenda.

8. Conclusion and Recommendations

8.1 Conclusion

The study surveyed 253 Pune-based consumers on what drives their FMCG consumption behavior. The findings were contrary to their behavior. The findings were not what we wanted to know — but what we found out is what is significant. 73.9% described themselves as rational buyers. The mean emotional ad agreement was significantly low ($M = 2.32$, $p < .001$). Yet 36.4% chose the emotionally framed juice in a blind scenario test and 64.1% described pleasure/warmth as their dominant post-purchase state. The study found that what Kahneman's dual-process theory says is true: that we tell a story on one level but do another on another level. The practical implication is that FMCG communication should include rational claims in the headline so that the consumer can see it and feel rational. The rest should include all other aspects through peripheral route advertising (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986). The consumer does not need to know that both are happening simultaneously.

The exploratory factor analysis showed that the three emotional marketing items (Q7, Q9, Q12) do not load onto a single latent construct. The result indicates the bifurcation of the data into two different factors: personal memory emotional susceptibility (Factor 1, measured using Q7 and Q9) and cultural heritage trust (Factor 2, measured using Q12). The two-factor structure implies that there should be differences between nostalgia-based and Ayurvedic-based strategies for market segmentation. In the binary logistic regression, it was found that nostalgia (Q9) was the most influential factor on emotional product choice in that every one-point increase in nostalgia susceptibility increased the odds of picking up the emotional product by 18%. However, the overall predictive model failed to achieve statistical significance, indicating that emotional product choice could depend on many different variables that the six-item survey measure cannot capture.

H0 cannot be rejected. H1 is empirically supported by the behavioral study results and also by the trends found using binary logistic regression analysis ($p=.094$ for nostalgia, Q9). H2 (demographic moderator) is not empirically supported due to lack of statistical significance, consistent with psychographic segmentation research in PubMed. H3 (video-based advertisement) is empirically supported but requires experimental validation.

8.2 Recommendations

Recommendations for FMCG brand managers:

1. Invest money on Reels and TikTok ads which tap into emotions specific to the type of the product category: nostalgia for heritage brands, happiness for candies, and coziness for home consumption items.
2. Create content on YouTube using two different formats: emotional stories for building brands and facts for points of comparisons/conversions.
3. Conduct brand mapping with emotion annually because consumer connection evolves over time, and neglecting it makes your brand irrelevant even before any metrics reflect it.

4. For brands with heritage story, focus on creating nostalgia-based appeal as it outperforms simple emotional appeal. According to regression analysis, nostalgia (Q9) is the only variable reaching the level of behavioral relevance in this research.

5. Don't confuse Ayurvedic heritage trust and nostalgia as being the same emotion. According to exploratory factor analysis, there are two distinct factors and thus require different marketing approaches and consumer segments.

Marketing research recommendations:

1. Conduct replication with $N \geq 300$ to check whether the marginal correlation between nostalgia and Q7 ($r = 0.123$, $p = .053$) remains significant and give enough statistical power to the nostalgia trend observed in the logistic regression.
2. Utilize Implicit Association Tests as well as other implicit measures to limit the effect of self-report data and minimize social desirability bias.
3. Enlarge the sampling frame to include consumers from Tier II Maharashtra cities (Nashik, Aurangabad, etc.) to see if results would hold true for consumers from those locations.
4. Develop new multi-item scales with no less than three items for each EFA-derived factor to estimate the internal reliability.

Recommendations for SIMS MBA Curriculum:

1. Cover neuromarketing through case studies, focusing on companies based in Maharashtra.
2. Partner with Pune-based FMCG companies in order to run A/B tests on effectiveness of emotional vs. rational copy.

9. Limitations and Future Research

9.1 Limitations

Convenience sampling limits generalizability to the consumer living in the urban area in Pune with access to digital technology. Populations in rural areas have been left out and the patterns of emotions elicited in relation to FMCG advertising may be different in the context.

The biggest methodological challenge associated with the study can be seen in self-report bias. Participants invariably tend to understate the extent to which emotions impact their purchase decisions. This means that the effect size is bigger than what is reported here. In spite of the attempt to overcome this problem through the use of the scenario-based question number 8, it is not an observation of actual purchase behavior.

A cross-sectional design makes causal inference impossible. While the connections between emotional marketing measures and the behaviors considered are established, the study lacks the capability to control for confounding variables.

It should be noted that the analysis did not distinguish between personal care products (toothpaste, skincare, and hair care) and food and beverages as far as testing correlations and running regressions are concerned. If the emotional triggers are different among these two sets of products, it is not possible to establish it with this research design.

Three continuous Likert items have been used to perform exploratory factor analysis. This is indeed a minimum number of items required for performing factor analysis. While the results obtained can be considered interpretable, a more robust factor structure requires at least two to three items per construct. Future versions of the questionnaire should aim to develop a factor structure of three Likert items for each of the emotions under consideration. The relatively poor Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin measure (KMO) (0.461) as well as a non-significant Bartlett's test ($p = .090$) indicate this quite clearly.

Logistic regression classifier accuracy is at 64.4% while the Nagelkerke pseudo- R^2 is 0.025, which means that there is only partial model fit for the sample. The reason behind such a deficiency can be attributed to the lack of several variables that can affect consumer behavior. The model should be regarded as exploratory rather than confirmatory. The non-significant overall model chi-square ($\chi^2(6) = 4.567$, $p = .601$) confirms that the six included predictors do not, collectively, reliably predict emotional product choice in this sample.

The borderline correlation between nostalgia (Q9) and emotional ad agreement Q7 ($r = 0.123$, $p = .053$) may reflect a Type II error. A sample of $N \geq 280$ would provide adequate statistical power to resolve this.

The impact of platform (H3) was studied descriptively rather than experimentally. The assumption that Reels/TikTok generates greater emotional arousal than other formats cannot be established from this study's self-report data alone.

9.2 Directions for Future Research

Longitudinal studies with the same consumer sample being followed over 12-24 months would reveal whether emotional brand relationships are enduring or change with exposure patterns and life changes.

Experimental studies with eye-tracking and GSR equipment would enable measuring implicit emotions towards FMCG advertising that self-report measures cannot capture at all.

Comparative studies across cities — Pune vs. Nashik, Aurangabad, Kolhapur — would reveal consumer dynamics in Tier II cities in Maharashtra and whether this study's findings are specific to Pune or more applicable to Maharashtra's consumer landscape as a whole.

Platform-specific content A/B testing in controlled conditions would establish causal relationships between emotional narrative formats and conversion rates in the Indian digital marketplace.

Extension to more product categories: replicating this study separately on personal care products (Patanjali, HUL brands) would yield a more complete set of emotional trigger antecedents for the Indian FMCG industry than this study's focus on food and beverage allows.

Post-pandemic comfort consumption: a study on how COVID-19 has permanently changed consumer associations with nostalgia and comfort in Indian FMCG purchasing behavior, whether this is category-specific, would be both timely and pragmatically useful to brands as they adjust their strategies.

Replication with an expanded questionnaire that includes at least three items per emotional dimension (nostalgia, joy, comfort, cultural trust) to allow sub-scale reliability estimation and more robust factor analysis, with particular attention to replicating and extending the two-factor personal-memory vs. cultural-heritage distinction identified in this study.

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A Project Report on
**"Impact of Emotional Marketing on the Buying Decisions of FMCG
Buyers in Pune"**

Submitted to SIMS, Kirkee, Pune
In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of
MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

By
Jay Sahastrabudhe
PRN No. 24020448083

Under the guidance of
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SYMBIOSIS INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES
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